

In Cabinet picks, loyalty reigns

BY WASHINGTON POST STAFF

President-elect Donald Trump has announced his picks for all key Cabinet and White House roles, with all Cabinet-level positions named and confirmation hearings now underway. Loyalty to the president was often a top consideration in Trump's picks, and in some instances, Trump and his team took an unorthodox approach, creating “czar” positions to oversee broad policy portfolios and picking people with controversial backgrounds and little relevant policy experience.



Follow the Senate confirmation hearings for Trump's Cabinet and more than 800 other top appointees.



JD Vance
VICE PRESIDENT*

JD Vance is a one-term senator from Ohio and one of the youngest vice presidents in history. A former Trump critic who wrote a best-selling memoir on his upbringing in rural Appalachia, he has worked over the years to align himself with Trump and is now one of his staunchest defenders.



Susie Wiles
WHITE HOUSE CHIEF OF STAFF*

Susie Wiles was Trump's campaign manager, leading his operation since 2021, and played a big role in charting his comeback. She will be the first female White House chief of staff.

*No Senate confirmation required



Marco Rubio
SECRETARY OF STATE

Marco Rubio is a senator from Florida and advocates a robust U.S. presence in the world. Rubio ran for president in 2016 and clashed bitterly with Trump in the Republican primary, though they repaired their relationship, and Trump considered Rubio as a potential running mate earlier this year.



Scott Bessent
TREASURY SECRETARY

Scott Bessent is a longtime hedge fund executive who made a fortune working for George Soros, the billionaire investor hated by much of the right, and emerged as a key adviser to Trump over the course of the 2024 presidential campaign. He has also taught economics at Yale.



Pete Hegseth
DEFENSE SECRETARY

Pete Hegseth is a combat veteran and Fox News host, who has criticized the Biden administration's approach to national security as weak. He is one of Trump's more controversial picks but appears to have won over many Republican senators in his confirmation hearing.



Pam Bondi
ATTORNEY GENERAL

Pam Bondi is a former Florida attorney general and longtime Trump loyalist who served on the defense team during his first impeachment trial. She also played a leading role in Trump's efforts to overturn the 2020 election results and is a partner at Ballard Partners, a powerhouse lobbying firm where Wiles once worked.



Doug Burgum
INTERIOR SECRETARY

Doug Burgum is governor of North Dakota and a staunch advocate of expanded fossil fuel production. Burgum helped develop the campaign's energy policy, and Trump also named him to a newly created “energy czar” position. But unlike many others in Trump's orbit, Burgum believes human activity is causing climate change.



Brooke Rollins
AGRICULTURE SECRETARY

Brooke Rollins is a former Trump White House policy adviser and the president of the America First Policy Institute, a group that has put together policy proposals for a second Trump term.



Howard Lutnick
COMMERCE SECRETARY

Howard Lutnick serves as co-chair of Trump's transition team and is the CEO and chairman of Cantor Fitzgerald, an investment firm. As commerce secretary, Lutnick would play a leading role in implementing the president's economic and trade agenda.



Lori Chavez-DeRemer
LABOR SECRETARY

Lori Chavez-DeRemer is a former congresswoman from Oregon and moderate Republican who has served on bipartisan congressional caucuses and has supported pro-union legislation. Her selection for the role marked an unusual nod toward the labor movement, but many rank-and-file union members embraced Trump in the election.



Robert F. Kennedy Jr.
HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES SECRETARY

Robert F. Kennedy Jr. is a former Democrat and independent 2024 presidential candidate who threw his support behind Trump in August. He is one of Trump's more controversial Cabinet picks, having founded a prominent anti-vaccine group and often promoted debunked claims about vaccine safety.



Scott Turner
HOUSING AND URBAN DEVELOPMENT SECRETARY

Scott Turner is a former professional football player who served in Trump's first administration as executive director of the White House Opportunity and Revitalization Council, which was tasked with investing in distressed areas.



Sean P. Duffy
TRANSPORTATION SECRETARY

Sean P. Duffy is a former congressman and Fox Business host. Before entering politics, he was a reality television star in the 1990s, appearing on MTV's “The Real World: Boston.” He served as district attorney of Ashland County, Wisconsin, before being elected to Congress as part of the Republican wave in 2010.



Chris Wright
ENERGY SECRETARY

Chris Wright is the head of fracking company Liberty Energy and a skeptic of mainstream science on global warming. The oil executive runs a foundation focused on promoting expanded fossil fuel production as a solution to many of the world's problems. Wright will also serve on Trump's planned National Energy Council.



Linda McMahon
EDUCATION SECRETARY

Linda McMahon is a major GOP donor and retired World Wrestling Entertainment executive who served as co-chair of Trump's transition team. McMahon led the Small Business Administration for two years during Trump's first term and has most recently chaired the board of the America First Policy Institute.



Douglas A. Collins
VETERANS AFFAIRS SECRETARY

Douglas A. Collins is an Iraq War veteran who is now a chaplain in the U.S. Air Force Reserve Command. Collins served in the House of Representatives from 2013 to 2021, and emerged as a strong loyalist during Trump's first impeachment inquiry, when he was the ranking Republican on the House Judiciary Committee.



Kristi L. Noem
HOMELAND SECURITY SECRETARY

Kristi L. Noem has served as the governor of South Dakota since 2019, and was an active supporter of Trump on the 2024 campaign trail. She previously served as the state's at-large member of the U.S. House and in the state legislature.



John Ratcliffe
CIA DIRECTOR

John Ratcliffe is a former Texas congressman and federal prosecutor. He served as director of national intelligence from 2020 to 2021 in the first Trump administration and is a stalwart Trump loyalist.



Stephen Miran
COUNCIL OF ECONOMIC ADVISERS CHAIR

Stephen Miran served as an economic policy adviser at the Treasury Department in the final year of the first Trump presidency. He is now a fellow at the Manhattan Institute and a senior strategist at the investment firm Hudson Bay Capital Management.



Lee Zeldin
ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY ADMINISTRATOR

Lee Zeldin is a former New York congressman who ran for New York governor in 2022. During his time in Congress, Zeldin sought to protect the Long Island Sound from dredge sediment dumping, but he also voted to end Clean Air Act standards. He is another strong defender of Trump.



Russell Vought
OFFICE OF MANAGEMENT AND BUDGET DIRECTOR

If confirmed, this will be Russell Vought's second time in the position. He was the director of the Office of Management and Budget in Trump's first presidency. Vought wrote a chapter on transforming the executive office in Project 2025, which is a conservative policy plan for the next Republican administration that Trump has tried to distance himself from.



Tulsi Gabbard
DIRECTOR OF NATIONAL INTELLIGENCE

Tulsi Gabbard is a former Democratic representative from Hawaii who unsuccessfully sought the Democratic presidential nomination in 2020, and later became a Republican. Gabbard, a military veteran, is a critic of foreign wars and helped Trump throughout the campaign. She is likely to face tough questions in her confirmation hearing over her unorthodox foreign policy views.



Michael Kratsios
PRESIDENTIAL SCIENCE ADVISER

Michael Kratsios previously served as the White House's chief technology officer, where he led the administration's efforts on artificial intelligence. He is Trump's pick to lead the White House Office of Science and Technology Policy.



Kelly Loeffler
SMALL BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION CHIEF

Kelly Loeffler is a former senator and the co-chair of Trump's inaugural committee. Loeffler, a former business executive, also fundraised heavily for Trump's 2024 campaign.



Jamieson Greer
TRADE REPRESENTATIVE

Jamieson Greer is a partner at King & Spalding in Washington, D.C., and served as chief of staff to U.S. Trade Representative Robert E. Lighthizer in Trump's first term.



Elise Stefanik
AMBASSADOR TO THE UNITED NATIONS

Elise Stefanik is a congresswoman from New York and the fourth most senior Republican in the House. She has emerged as an outspoken defender of Trump and has been sharply critical of the United Nations, especially regarding its handling of the Israel-Gaza War.